

Minorian Reference Phonology

Consonant Inventory

	Bilabial	Dental	Alveolar	Post-Alveolar	Retroflex	Palatal	Velar	Uvular	Glottal
Plosive	p b		t d				k g	q ɢ	
Fricative	ɸ (β)	θ (ð)	s z	ʃ			x (ɣ)	χ (ʁ)	(h)
Affricate				tʃ					
Nasal	m		n			ɲ	ŋ	(ɴ)	
Lateral			l						
Trill			r						
Liquid	w			(ɭ)	j	(w)			

Notes

- All voiceless plosives are aspirated except when following /s/.
- All voiced plosives become spirantized when between voiced sonorants or vowels.
- All non-sibilant fricatives become voiced at the end of a word when following a vowel.
- /r/ becomes [ɻ] in coda positions immediately following vowels.
- /r/, /ɻ/ may be tapped when not geminated.
- /x/ becomes [h] in onset positions.
- Some speakers retract /ɸ/ and [β] to [f] and [v], respectively.
- /ŋ/ becomes [ɴ] before uvular stops

Vowel Inventory

	Front		Central	Back	
	Short	Long		Short	Long
Close	i y	i: y:		u	u:
Near Close	(ɪ)			(ʊ)	
Close-Mid	e (ø)	e: ø:	ə	(o)	o:
Mid	(ɐ)		ə		
Open-Mid	(ɛ) (œ)	ɛ: œ:		(ɔ)	ɔ:
Open	æ	æ:	(a)	ɑ	ɑ:
Nasal	æ̃	æ̃:	ã	ã	ã:
Diphthongs	aæ eɔ e:ɔ ɔ:ɪ				

Notes

- All short unrounded plain vowels and /ɛ:/ become /ə/ in unstressed syllables, except for /i/, which becomes [ɪ].
- All short nasal vowels become /ẽ/ in unstressed syllables.
- All short rounded vowels and /ø:/, /o:/, /œ:/, /ɔ:/ become /ə/ in unstressed syllables.
- All nasal vowels may become closer to mid-height depending on the speaker.
- All long vowels become short in unstressed syllables, except /ø:/, /o:/, /œ:/, /ɔ:/, which as mentioned before, reduce.
- /ø:/, /o:/, /œ:/, /ɔ:/ become short in syllables with secondary stress.
- Some speakers may pronounce /ɑ/, /e/, /u/ as [a], [ɐ], [ʊ]

Phonotactics

The maximum syllable structure of Minorian is $(C)^3V(C)^5$ when analyzed without syllabic consonants and $(C)^3V(C)^3$ when analyzed with syllabic consonants. The following section will use the former analysis

Syllable-Level Rules

Onset

- **Null Onset**
- **Single Onset**
 - Any consonant that isn't /ŋ/;
- **Double Onset**
 - Any plosive or fricative (besides /x/ and /χ/) + /l/, /r/, or /j/ with the exception of the cluster /kj/;
 - Any voiceless plosive or fricative (besides /x/ and /χ/) + /ŋ/, /ŋ/, or /ŋ/ with the exception of the clusters /pŋ/ and /tŋ/;
 - Any plosive or fricative (besides /x/) + /m/, /n/, or /ɲ/ with the exception of the clusters /bm/, /pm/, /dn/, and /tn/;
 - Any plosive or fricative (besides /b/, /p/, /q/, /g/, and /χ/) + /w/;
 - /s/ + any voiceless plosive;
- **Triple Onset**
 - /s/ + any voiceless plosive (besides /k/ or /q/), /ϕ/, or /θ/ + /r/.

Nucleus

- Any vowel can serve as the nucleus of a syllable;
- **Restrictions**
 - Nasal vowels cannot occur in syllables where the first consonant of the coda was a nasal consonant.
 - /i/ and /i:/ cannot occur in syllables that had /ɲ/ in their onsets.

Coda

- **Null Coda**
- **Single Coda**
 - Any consonant;
- **Double Coda**
 - /l/ or /r/ + any plosive or fricative;
 - /m/ or /n/ + any plosive with the exception of the clusters /mb/, /nd/, /nk/, /ng/, /nq/, and /ng/;

- /ŋ/ or /ŋ/ + any voiceless plosive with the exception of the clusters /ŋp/ and /ŋt/;
- /ŋ/ + /k/ or /q/;
- /s/ + any voiceless plosive (besides /k/ and /q/);
- /f/ + any voiceless stop or plosive;
- /b/ + /n/ or /ŋ/;

- **Triple Coda**

- /f/ + /s/ + any voiceless plosive (besides /k/ and /q/).

Word-Level Rules

Word-Initial

- **Restrictions**

- /z/ may not be present word-initially.

Word-Medial

- Most clusters, including geminates, are allowed;

- **Restrictions**

- Hiatus is not allowed;
- No /sp/ or /st/ + /sp/, /st/, /sɸ/, /sθ/, or /ʃ/;
- No clusters involving voiceless sonorants unless said clusters are geminates;
- No geminates that aren't between vowels, unless the geminated consonant follows a vowel and precedes a /w/;
- No /n/ + velar or uvular stops;
- No velar-uvular or uvular-velar consonant clusters;
- No clusters involving /ŋ/ unless said cluster is geminated /ŋ/;
- No clusters involving two distinct sibilants in contact with each other (e.g. no /sz/, /zs/, /ʃs/ &c.);
- No /bm/, /pm/, /dn/, /tn/, /mb/, /nd/, /ŋp/, /ŋt/;
- No mixed-voice clusters of plosives, fricatives, or both (e.g. no /sb/, /dsθ/ &c.).

Word-Finally

- Any combination of a coda and onset is allowed to occur as a word-final consonant cluster (you can thank high-vowel apocope for leading to such monstrosities as /fɪpsθr/) except those that violate the word-medial restrictions (e.g. no word-final clusters like /zɸr/) and clusters ending in /j/ or /w/. This is where the (C)⁵ in the syllable structure analysis comes from.

Romanization

Obviously, I'm not gonna write everything using the International Phonetic Alphabet because it's very ugly. Here is a table of letter-to-sound correspondences

Letter	Phoneme
a	/ɑ/
aa	/ɑ:/
ae	/ɑæ/
ã	/ã/
ãa	/ã:/
ä	/æ/
äa	/æ:/
ẽa	/ẽ/
ãä	/ẽ:/
b	/b/
ch	/tʃ/
d	/d/
e	/e/
ee	/e:/
ẽ	/ẽ/
ê	/ɛ:/
eo	/eq/
eeo	/e:q/
f	/f/
g	/g/
hm	/ŋ/
hn	/ŋ/

hny	/ɲ/
hl	/l̥/
hr	/r̥/
i	/i/
ii	/iː/
j	/j/
k	/k/
l	/l/
m	/m/
n	/n/
ng	/ŋ/
ny	/ɲ/
o	/ɔː/
ô	/oː/
ö	/e/
ö	/øː/
ø	/œː/
oi	/ɔːi̯/
p	/p/
q	/q/
qg	/ɢ/
qh	/χ/
r	/r/
s	/s/
sh	/ʃ/
t	/t/

þ	/θ/
u	/u/
uu	/u:/
ü	/y/
üu	/y:/
w	/w/
x	/x/
z	/z/

Diacritics

Diacritics are used to clear up ambiguity and make things look a little nicer. The romanization of Minorian uses one diacritic, whose function is listed in the table below.

Diacritic	Function
ǿ	Marks gemination on a multigraph (e.g. šh represents /ʃ:/)

Stress and Prosody

Minorian has both lexical and prosodic stress. The primary stress of a word falls on the first syllable of said word. Secondary stresses fall on the third, fifth, seventh, &c. syllables. Prosodic stress usually falls on the last word of a prosodic phrase, though it could fall elsewhere for emphasis. Prosodic phrases are usually separated by pauses in speech and usually constituted single clauses.